

folder under the OS—the place where you are most likely to save all your documents, e-mails, pictures, and so on. The indexing service itself runs as a service in the background and is constantly indexing all your content (the service runs at a very low priority and doesn't impact performance). While indexing is done on specific folders by default, you can change its settings through the Control Panel by double-clicking the Indexing and Search Options icon. Moreover, as noted earlier, you can also add a location to an index every time you run a search query on that particular location.

Tip

Vista's search supports advanced operators such as `author:`, `kind:`, and `tag:`. You can thus fashion a query that will search for all the files written by "John" and tagged with "vista" and "inprogress". Thus your query would be `-author:Robert tag:vista tag:inprogress`

5.3 Saved Searches

An interesting offshoot of the search feature under Vista is the concept of a virtual folder, or a saved search. A virtual folder is essentially a saved search: say you frequently look for information containing the keyword "John".



Saved search results

The search results on the query John can then be saved as a virtual folder. Such a VF will automatically refresh its contents with whichever new content piece is added to your system with the